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Retracted — TryHackMe WriteUp



Fritzadriano · [Follow](#)

6 min read · Sep 4, 2024

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I Investigate the case of the missing ransomware. After learning about Wazuh previously, today's task is a bit different.

It's still part of the Endpoint Security module that we need to address. We have a ransomware case that we need to solve as cybersecurity engineers.



Source: www.getduplicated.com

So, firstly let's see what is going on

A Mother's Plea

"Thanks for coming. I know you are busy with your new job, but I did not know who else to turn to."

"So I downloaded and ran an installer for an antivirus program I needed. After a while, I noticed I could no longer open any of my files. And then I saw that my wallpaper was different and contained a terrifying message telling me to pay if I wanted to get my files back. I panicked and got out of the room to call you. But when I came back, everything was back to normal."

"Except for one message telling me to check my Bitcoin wallet. But I don't even know what a Bitcoin is!"

"Can you help me check if my computer is now fine?"

Connecting to the Machine

Start the virtual machine in split-screen view by clicking on the green "Start Machine" button on the upper right section of this task. If the VM is not visible, use the blue "Show Split View" button at the top-right of the page. Alternatively, you can connect to the VM using the credentials below via "Remote Desktop".



Username	sophie
Password	fluffy1960
IP	10.10.223.35

Source: TryHackMe

"Oh, the password doesn't work? Wait, I have it written somewhere. Uhhh... Try this:"



Username	sophie
Password	fluffy19601234!
IP	10.10.223.35

Source: TryHackMe

TASK 2: The Message

So, as soon as you finish logging in to the computer, you'll see a file on the desktop addressed to me."

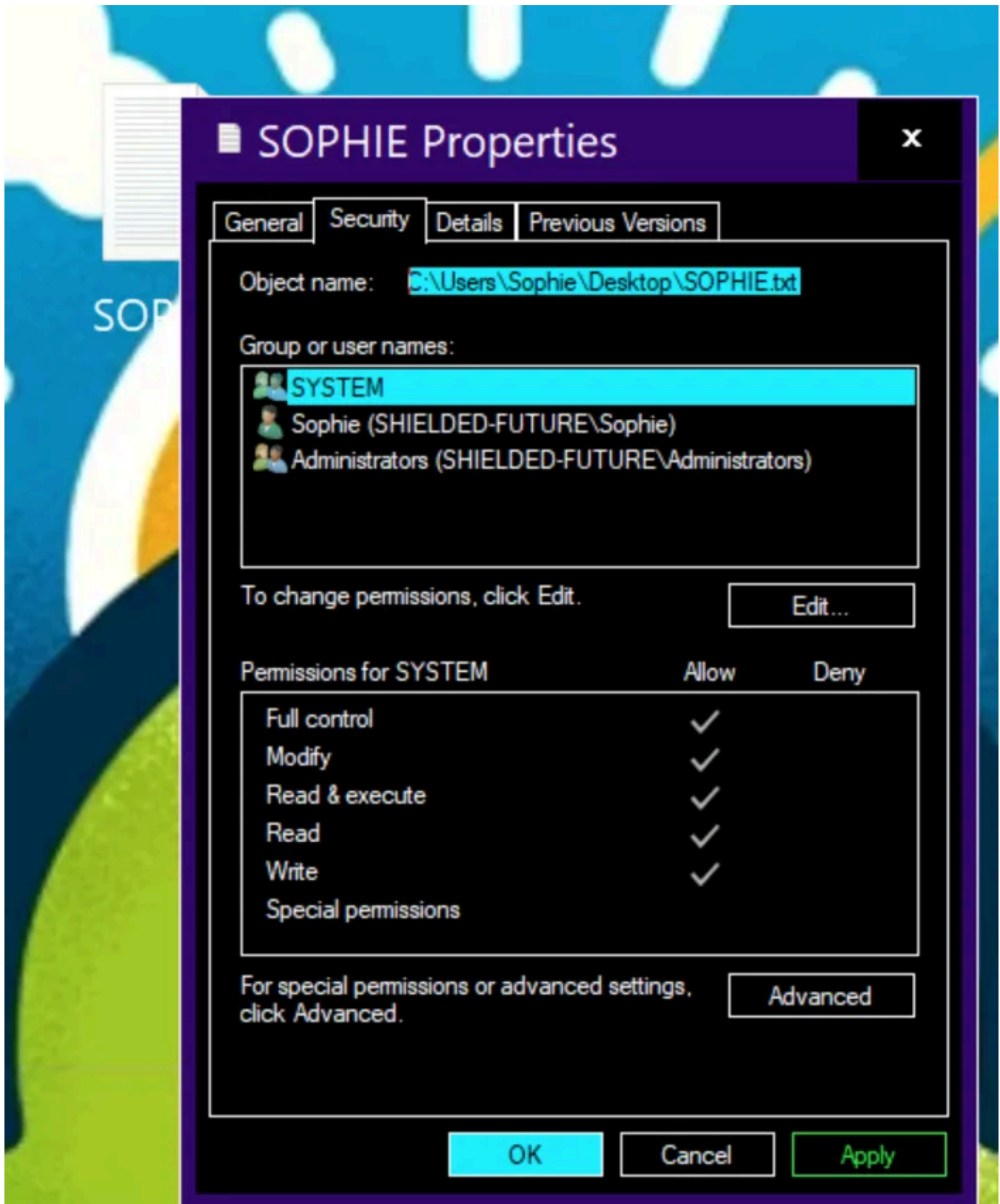
"I have no idea why that message is there and what it means. Maybe you do?"

Question 1

What is the full path of the text file containing the "message"?

A: C:\Users\Sophie\Desktop\SOPHIE.txt

You will find it right away when you check the details in the properties feature of Notepad



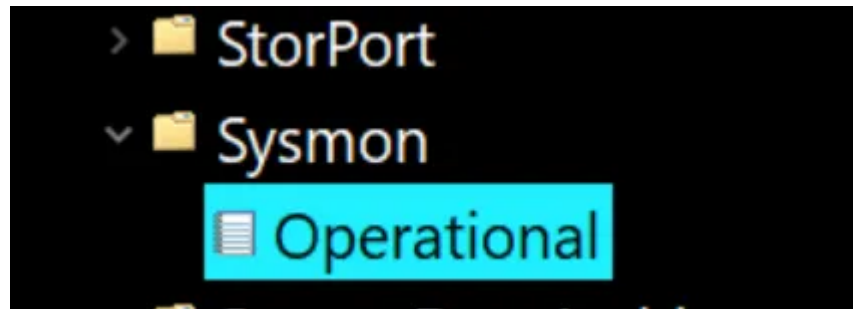
Source: TryHackMe

Question 2

You will find it right away when you check the details in the properties feature of Notepad

A: notepad.exe

This is where it gets a little technical. You can go to Event Viewer, as we learned before, and navigate to the *Application and Service Logs* (since it was an app) → *Microsoft* → *Windows* → *Sysmon* → and finally, *Operational*.

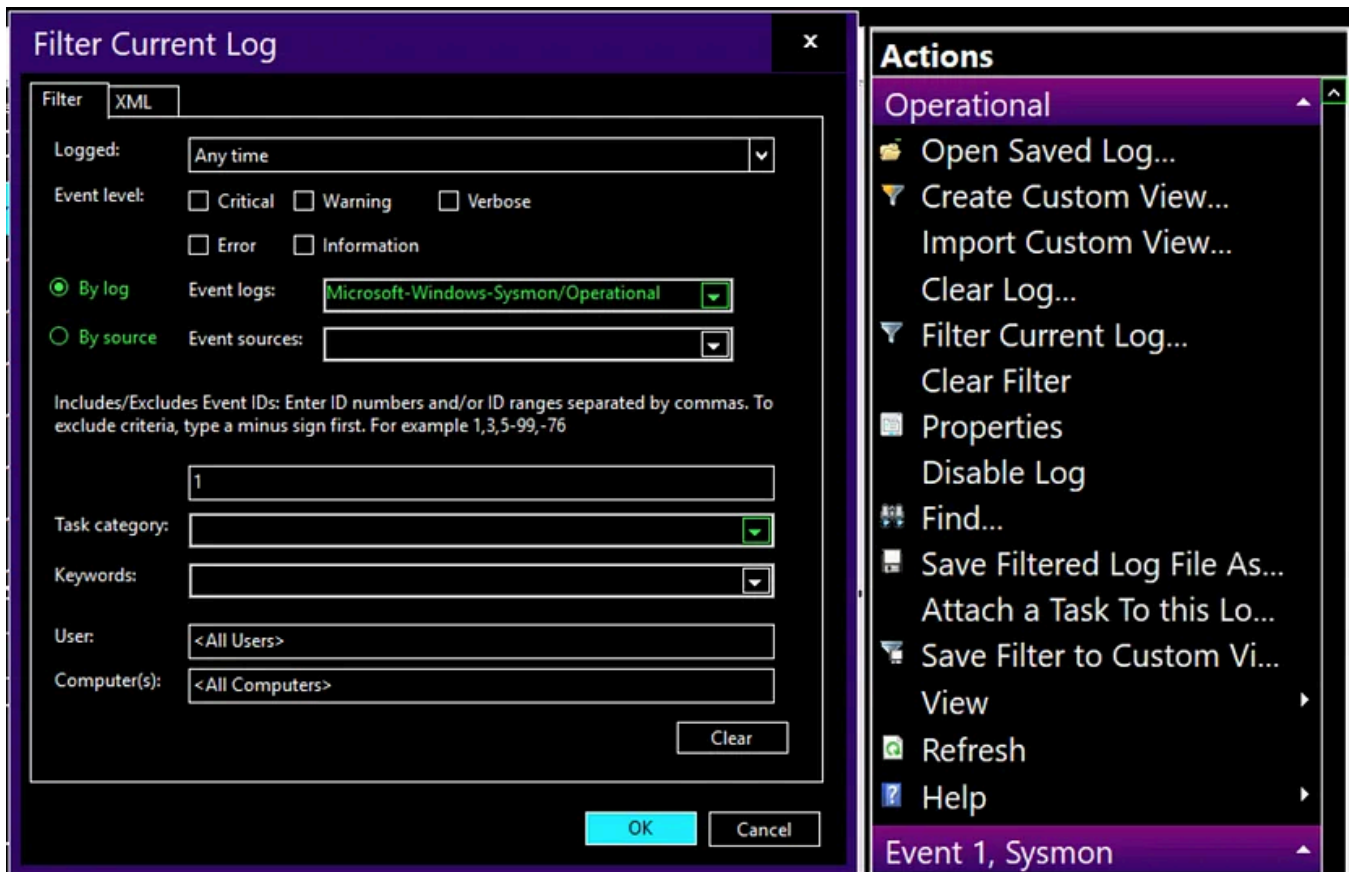


Source: TryHackMe

Since we want to find the file name as well as the process that created the file, we will use the 'Process Create' task category, which is considered as **Event ID 1**. I'll use this for the filter to speed up the search.

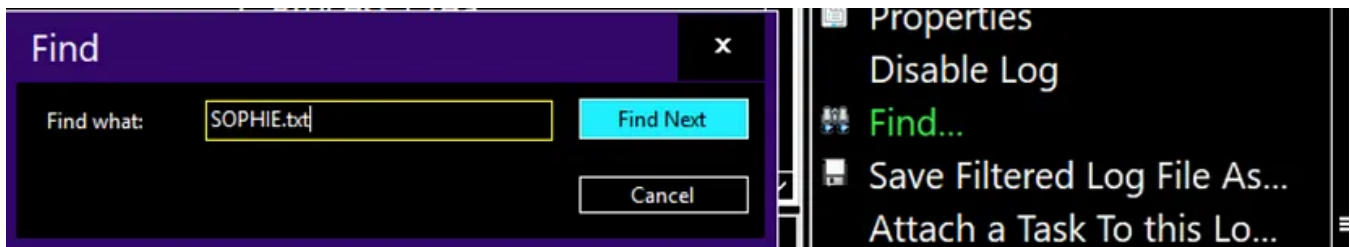
Operational Number of events: 3,348					
Filtered: Log: Microsoft-Windows-Sysmon/Operational; Source: ; Event ID: 1. Number of events: 1,708					
Level	Date and Time	Source	Event ID	Task Category	
Information	9/4/2024 6:00:38 AM	Sysmon	1	Process Crea...	
Information	9/4/2024 6:00:01 AM	Sysmon	1	Process Crea...	
Information	9/4/2024 5:55:37 AM	Sysmon	1	Process Crea...	
Information	9/4/2024 5:55:37 AM	Sysmon	1	Process Crea...	
Information	9/4/2024 5:55:37 AM	Sysmon	1	Process Crea...	
Information	9/4/2024 5:53:27 AM	Sysmon	1	Process Crea...	
Information	9/4/2024 5:51:55 AM	Sysmon	1	Process Crea...	

Source: TryHackMe



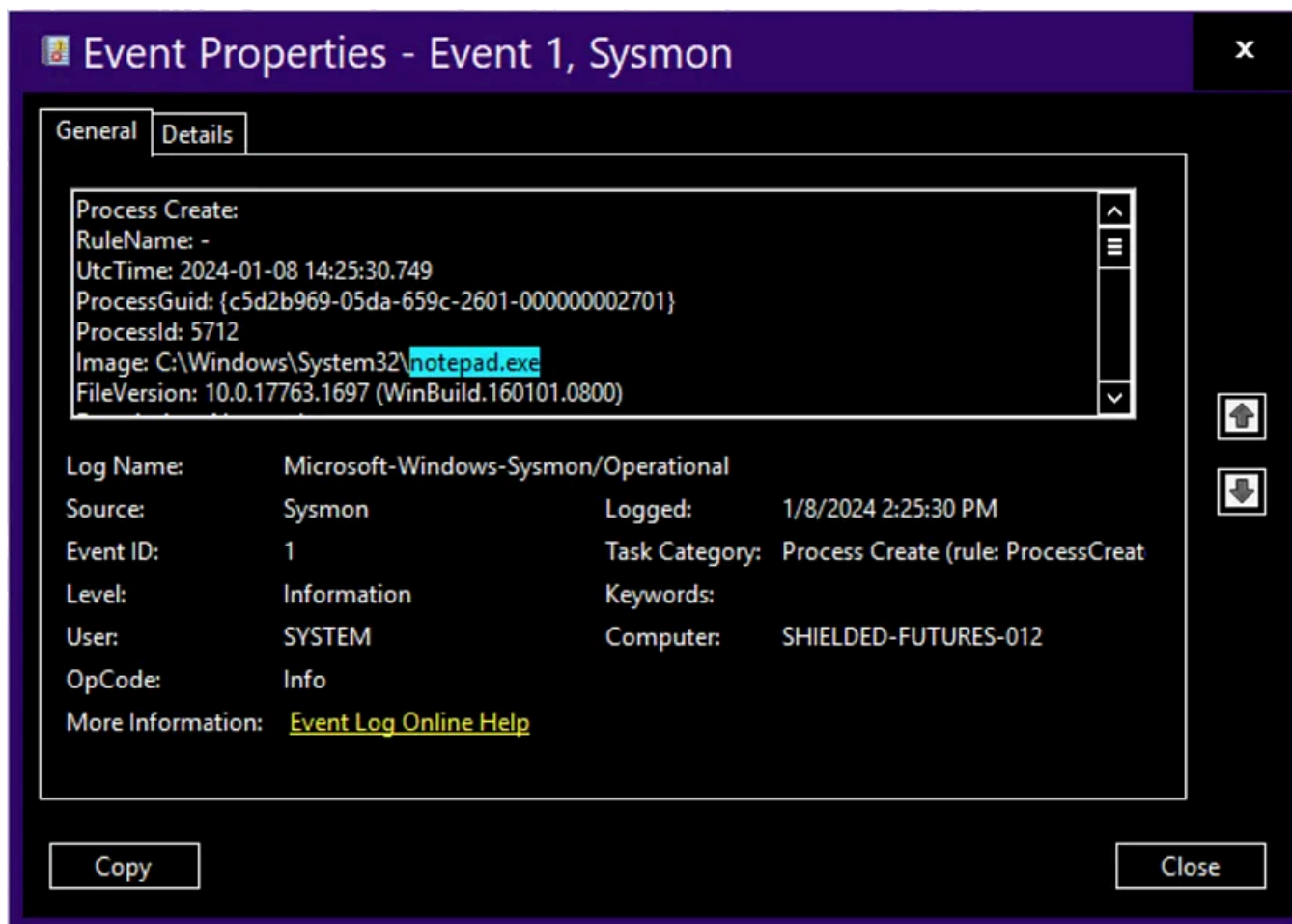
Source: TryHackMe

In the next step, we'll have dozens of Event ID 1 entries, but we still won't know which one to click. So, we'll need to specifically search for the file **SOPHIE.txt**



Source: TryHackMe

And here we go, we've found the file !!



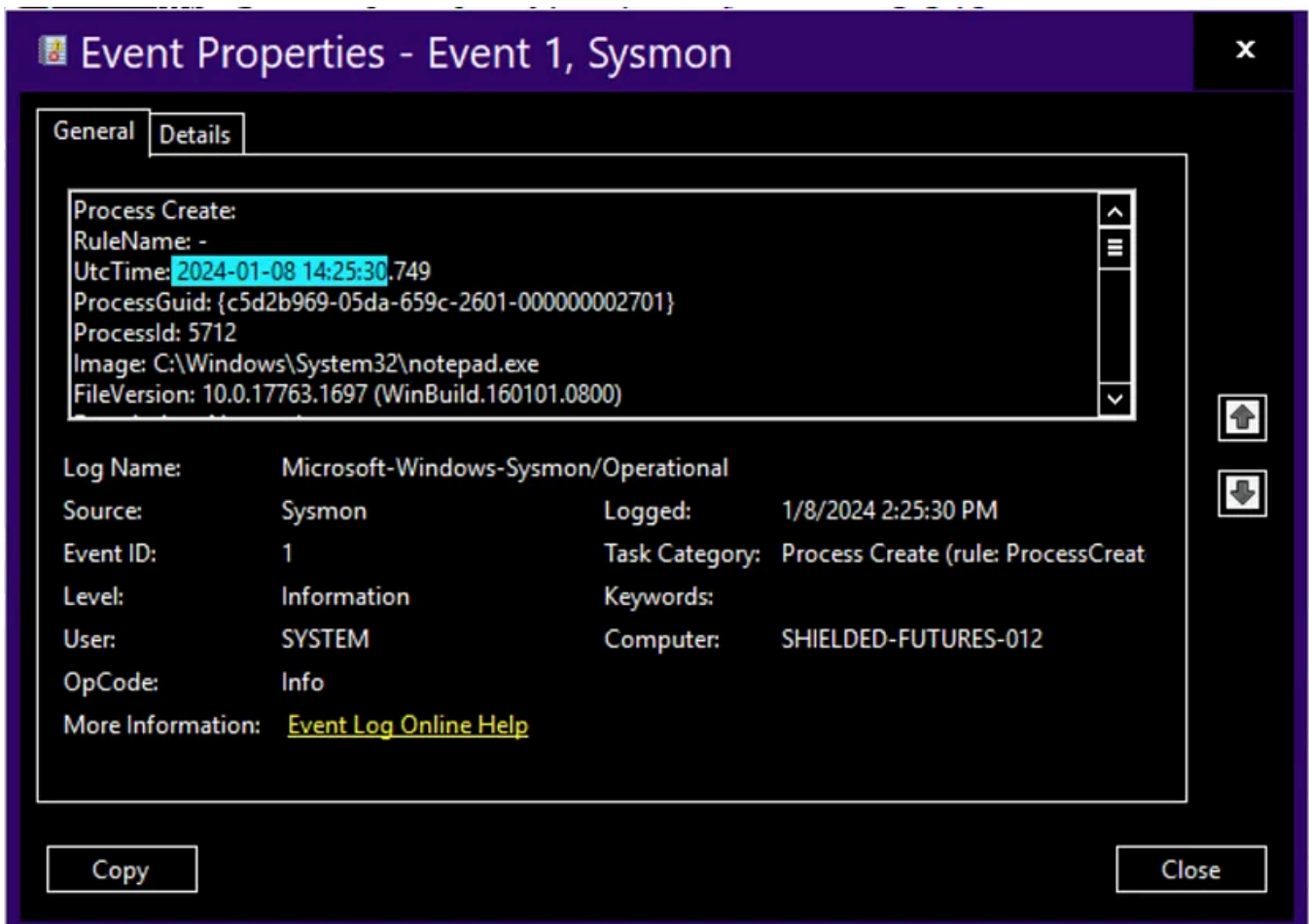
Source: TryHackMe

Question 3

What is the time of execution of the process that created the text file? Timezone UTC (Format YYYY-MM-DD hh:mm:ss)

A: 2024-01-08 14:25:30

We've already found it, along with the file extension.



Source: TryHackMe

Task 3: Something Wrong

“I swear something went wrong with my computer when I ran the installer. Suddenly, my files could not be opened, and the wallpaper changed, telling me to pay.”

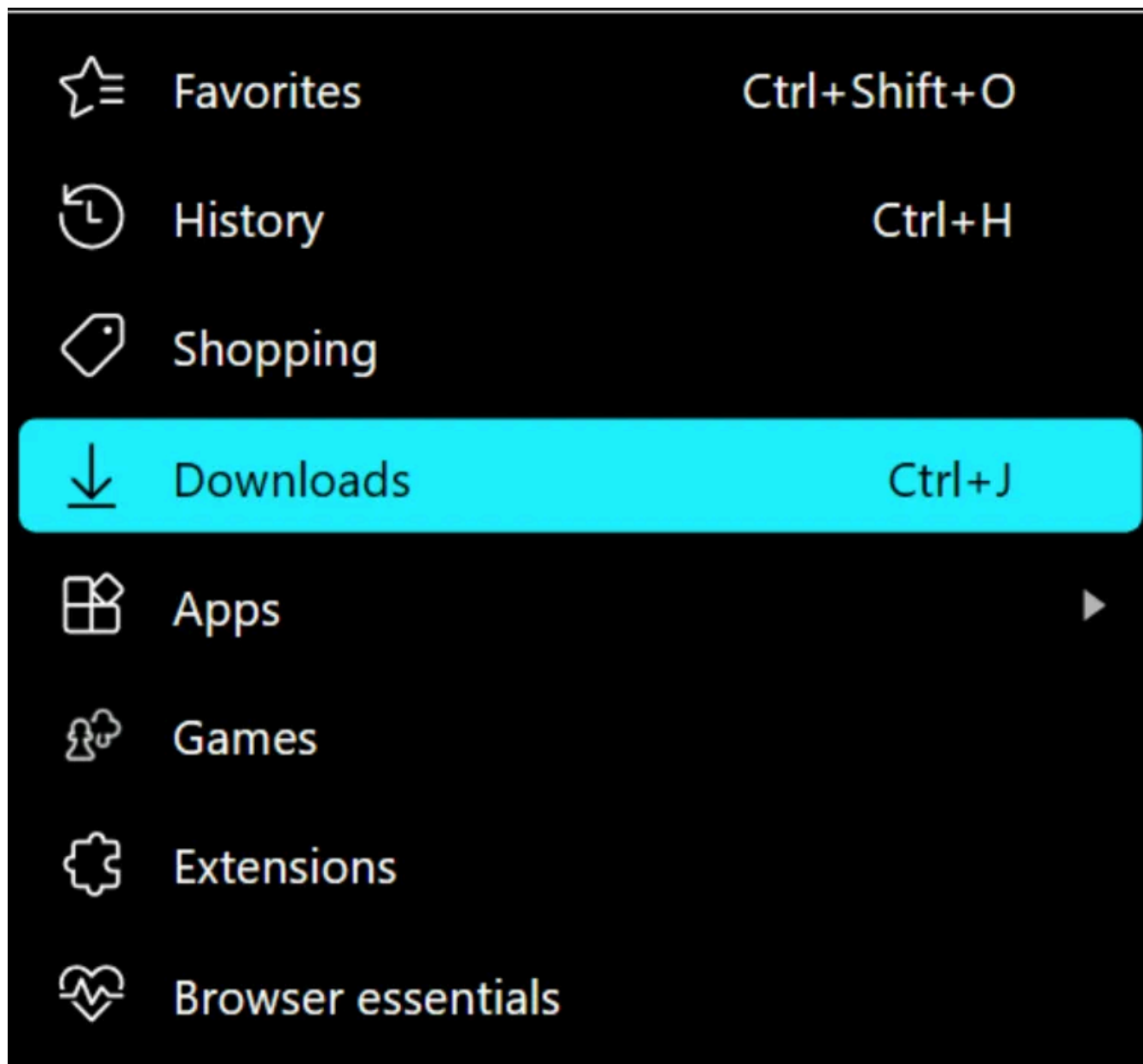
“Wait, are you telling me that the file I downloaded is a virus? But I downloaded it from Google!”

Question 1

What is the filename of this “installer”? (Including the file extension)

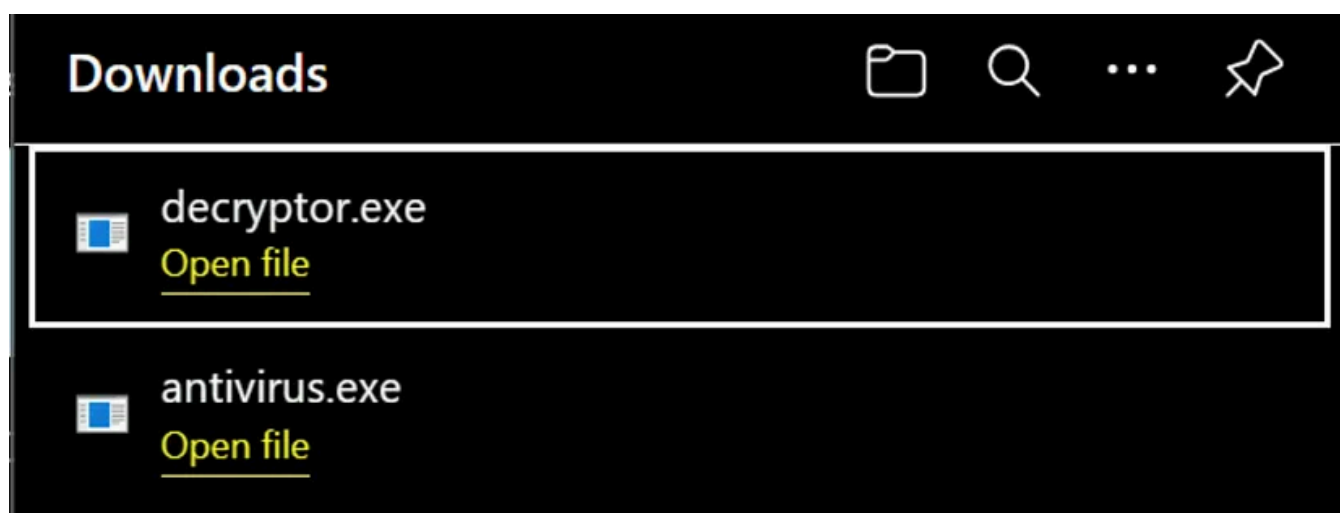
A: antivirus.exe

Let's see, maybe we can find it on the 'Google' she's been talking about. We just need to go to the 'Downloads history' section.



Source: TryHackMe

BINGO!! We've got it!



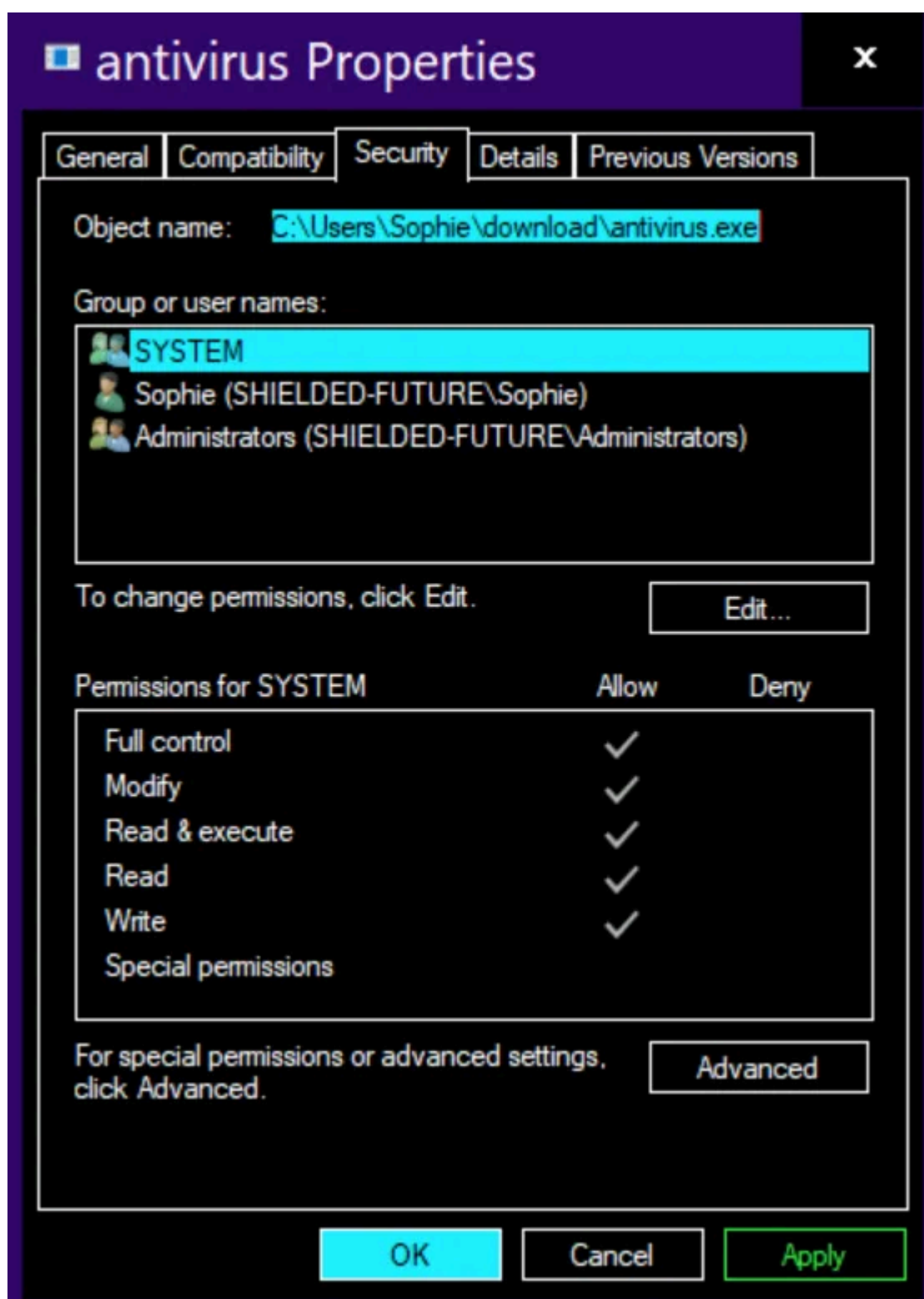
Source: TryHackMe

Question 2

What is the download location of this installer?

A: C:\Users\Sophie\download

Similarly, if you want to simplify things, just 'inspect' the file using the properties feature.



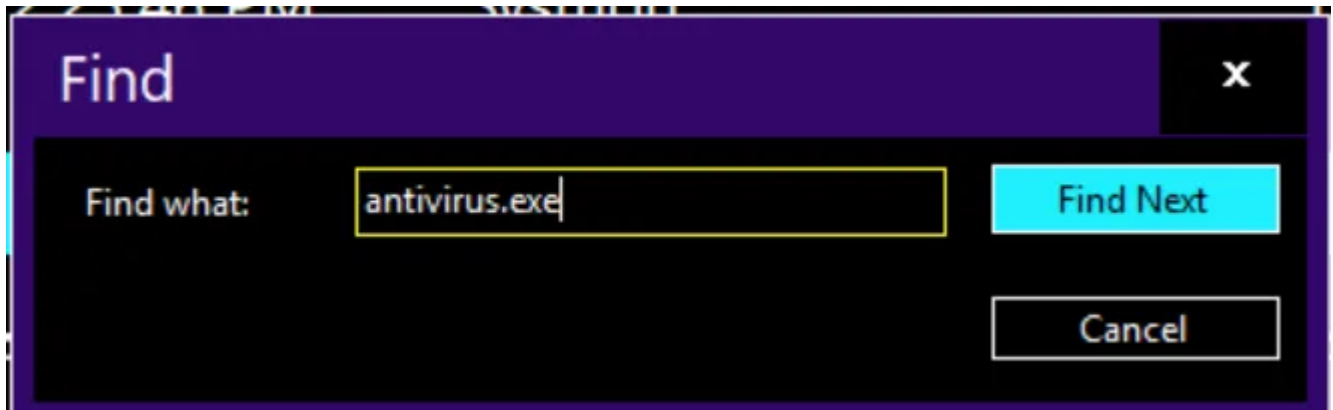
Source: TryHackMe

Question 3

The installer encrypts files and then adds a file extension to the end of the file name. What is this file extension?

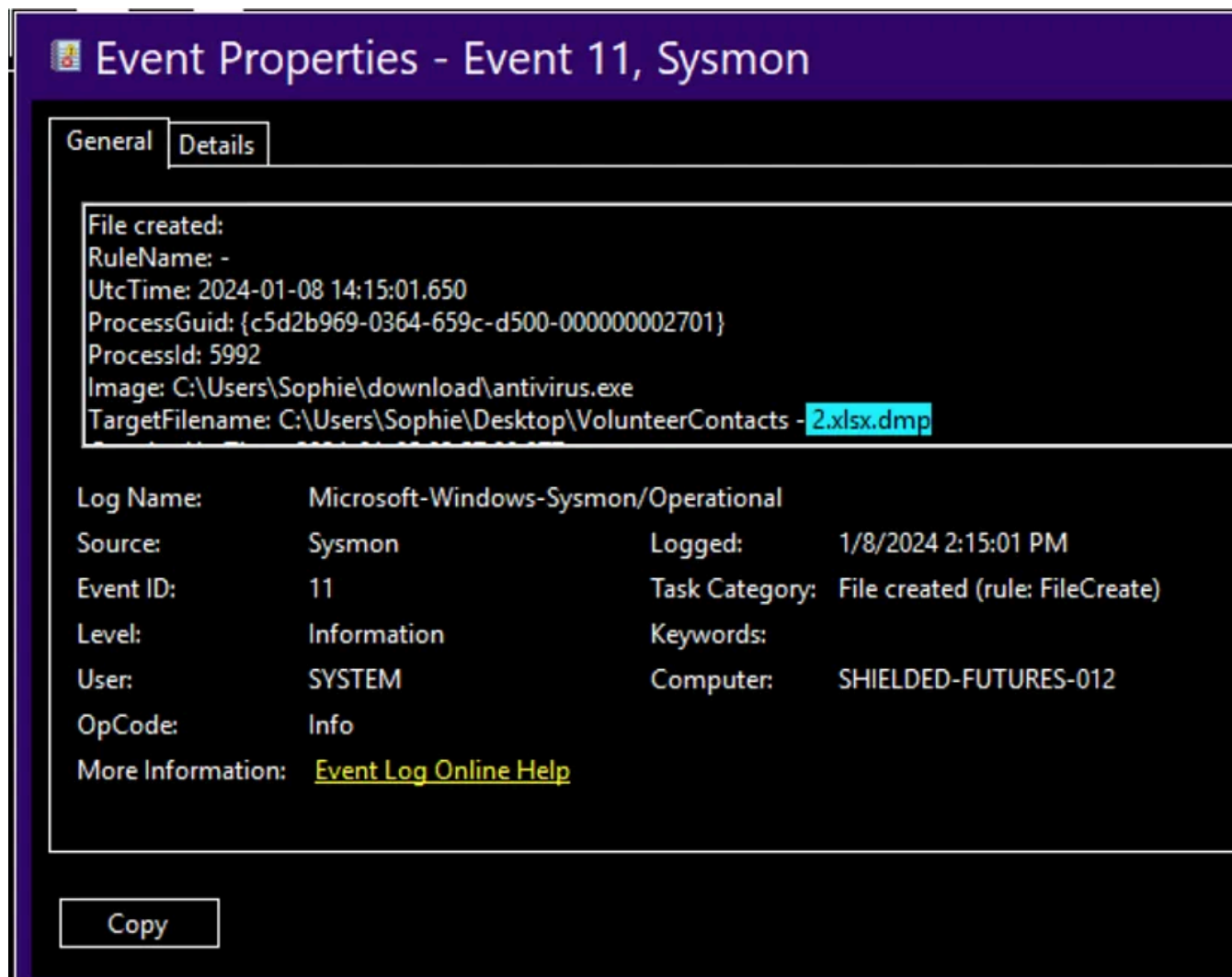
A: .dmp

Back in the Event Viewer, we need to search for the file using the 'Find' search bar. Don't forget to clear the filter, as we won't be using it anymore.



Source: TryHackMe

After searching for '*antivirus.exe*', since the question is about file creation, we will focus on Event ID 11, which represents '*File Created*'.



Source: TryHackMe

Question 4

The installer reached out to an IP. What is this IP?

A: 10.10.8.111

We've noticed that to find the IP address, we need to use Event ID 3, as it pertains to the network connect task category

Filter Current Log

Filter

XML

Logged:

Any time

Event level:

☐ Critical ☐ Warning ☐ Verbose ☐ Error ☐ Information

☒ By log

Event logs:

Microsoft-Windows-Sysmon/Operational

☐ By source

Event sources:

Includes/Excludes Event IDs: Enter ID numbers and/or ID ranges separated by commas. To exclude criteria, type a minus sign first. For example 1,3,5-99,-76

3

Task category:

Keywords:

User:

<All Users>

Computer(s):

<All Computers>

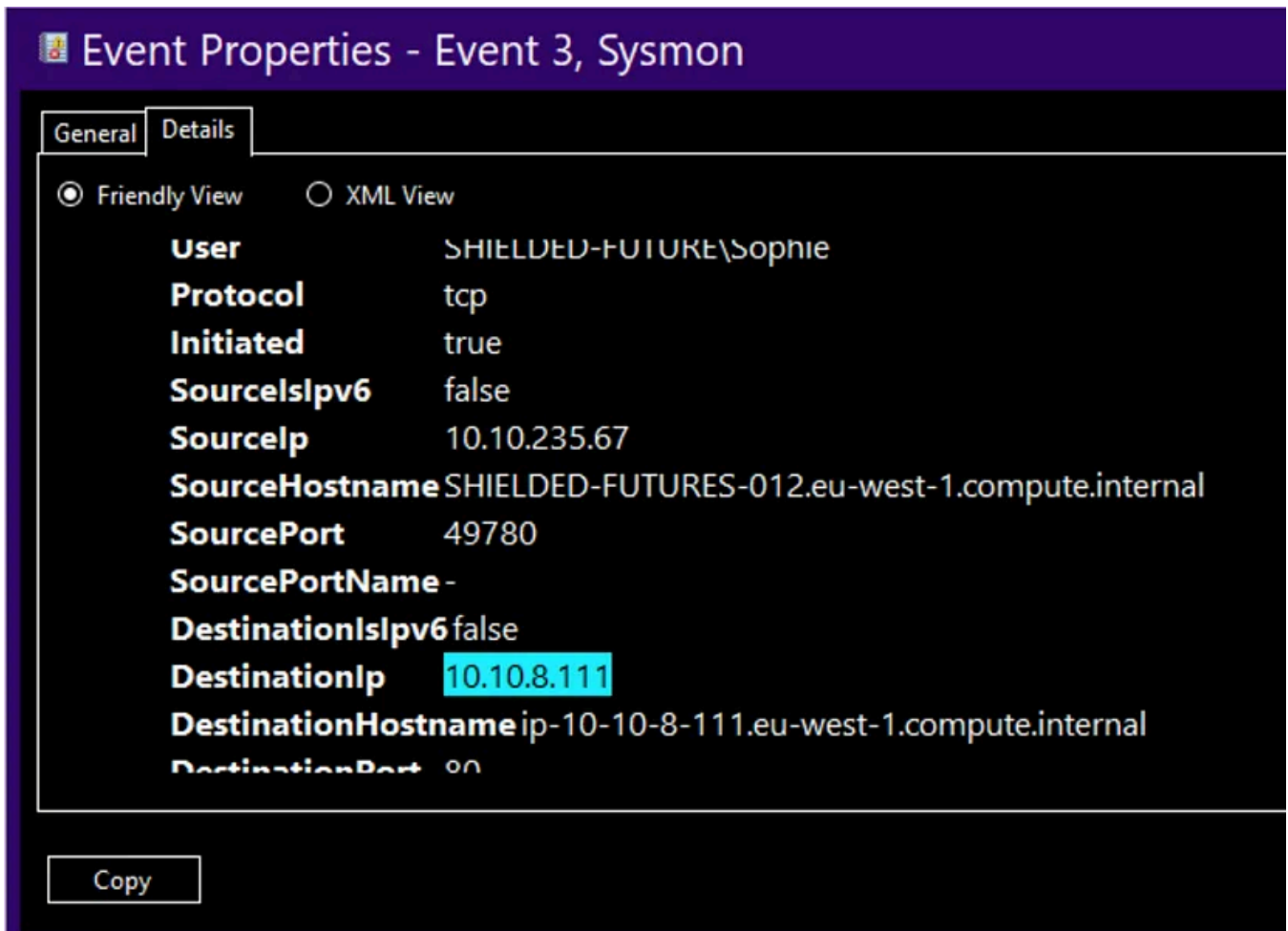
Clear

OK

Cancel

Source: TryHackMe

After that, we will find the Destination IP by looking it up in the Details feature



Source: TryHackMe

TASK 4

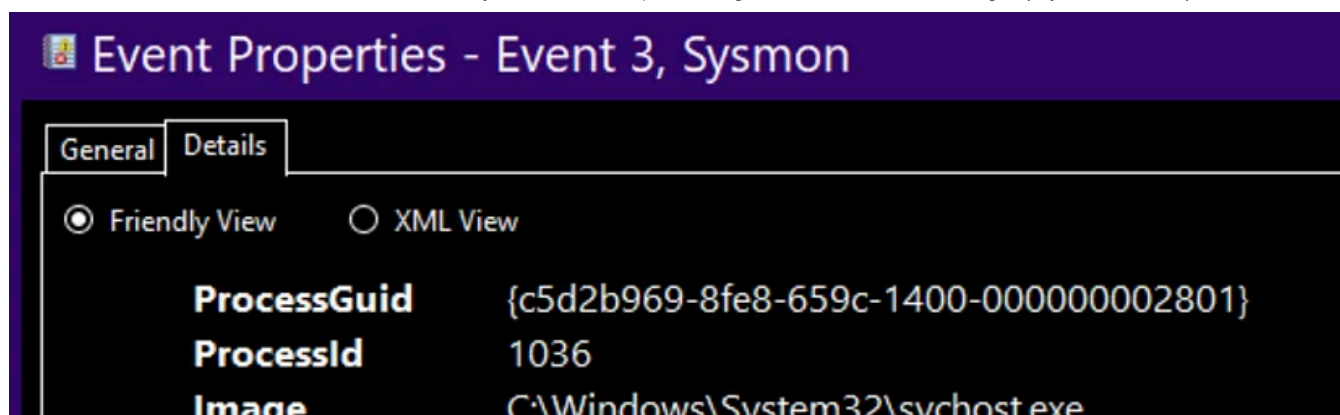
“So what happened to the virus? It does seem to be gone since all my files are back.”

Question 1

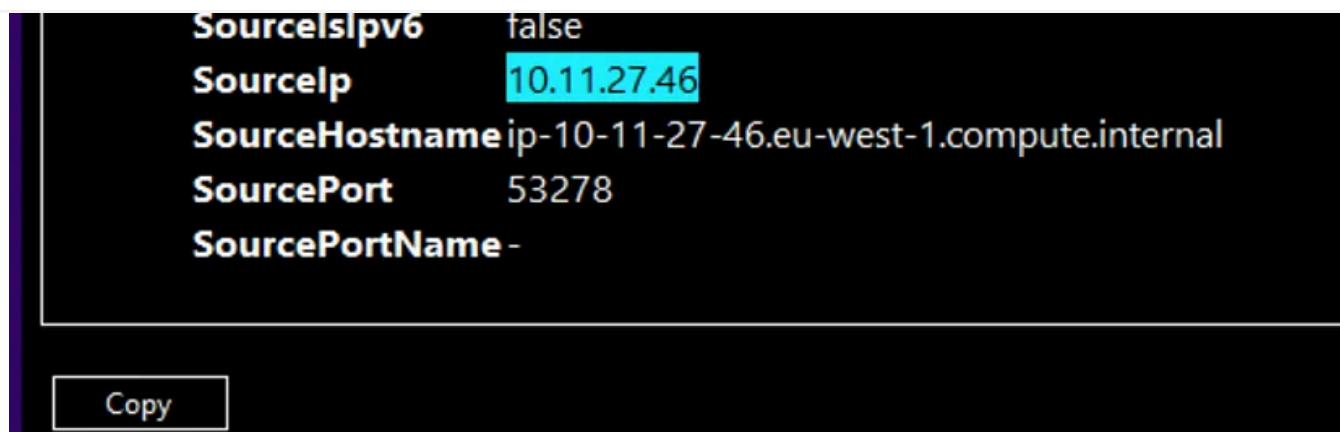
The threat actor logged in via RDP right after the “installer” was downloaded.
What is the source IP?

A: 10.11.27.46

Still within the Event ID 3 filter (since we want to find IP addresses), we just need to search for ‘RDP’ to get the IP. And there we go, we’ve got the IP.

[Open in app ↗](#)

Medium



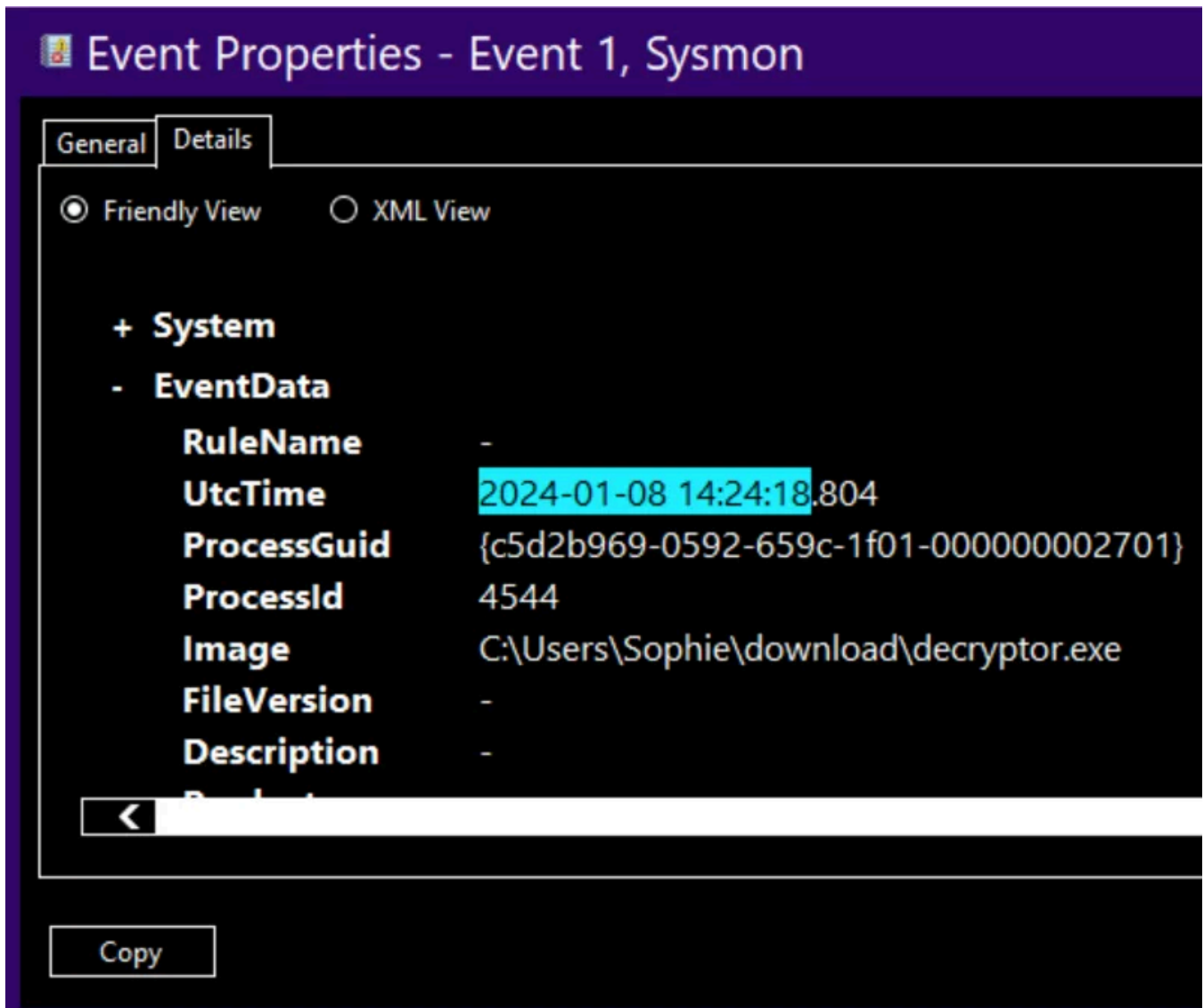
Source: TryHackMe

Question 2

This other person downloaded a file and ran it. When was this file run? Timezone UTC (Format YYYY-MM-DD hh:mm:ss)

A: 2024-01-08 14:24:18

Since we want to see when the file was run at a specific time, we need to switch back to **Event ID 1** and use the `decryptor.exe` file that we haven't used before. Let's see if it works and is usable.



Source: TryHackMe

And there you go, we've found the UTC time after searching for `decryptor`

Task 5: Doesn't Make Sense

"So you're telling me that someone accessed my computer and changed my files but later undid the changes?"

"That doesn't make any sense. Why infect my machine and clean it afterwards?"

"Can you help me make sense of this?"

Arrange the following events in sequential order from 1 to 7, based on the timeline in which they occurred.

Question 1-7

1. Sophie downloaded the malware and ran it

2. The malware encrypted the files on the computer and showed a ransomware note
3. The malware encrypted the files on the computer and showed a ransomware note
4. Someone else logged into Sophie's machine via RDP and started looking around
5. The intruder downloaded a decryptor and decrypted all the files
6. A note was created on the desktop telling Sophie to check her Bitcoin
7. We arrive on the scene to investigate

And there you go, the Sophie problem with her computer is resolved. The main issue lies with people who lack understanding or knowledge about cybercrime today.

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Written by Fritzadriano

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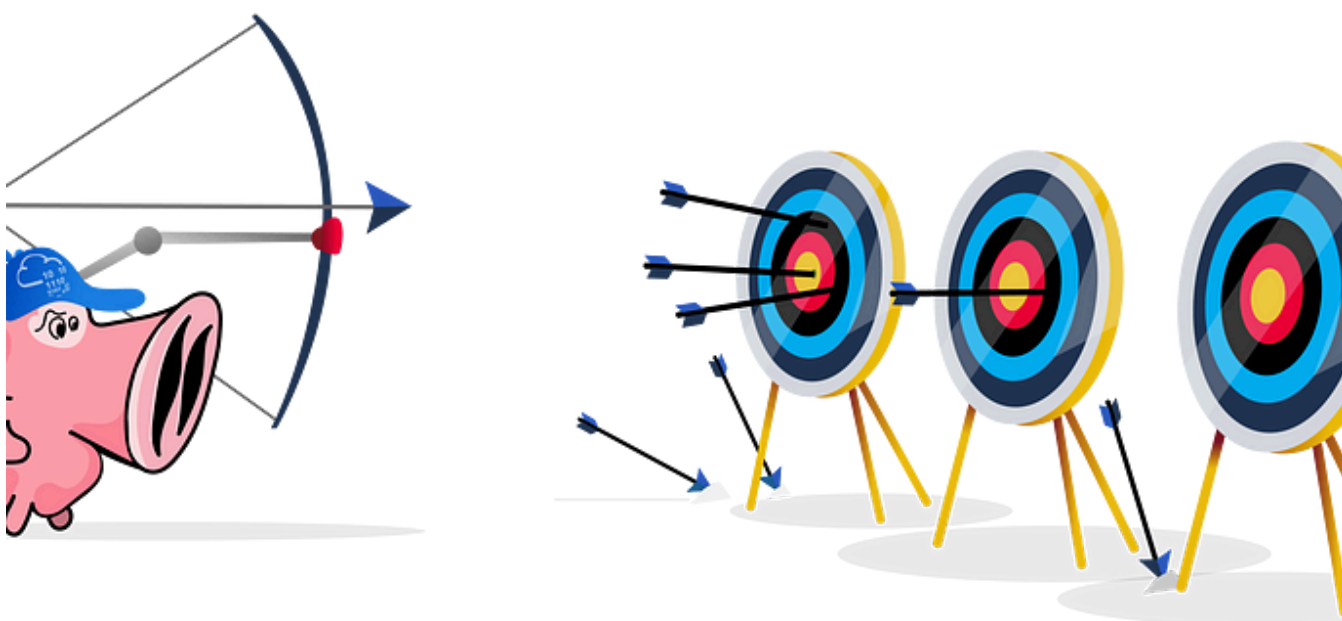
No responses yet



What are your thoughts?

Respond

More from Fritzadriano



 Fritzadriano

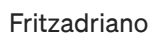
Snort Challenge— The Basics WriteUp (Part 1)

Today's writeup aims to investigate a series of traffic data and stop malicious activity under two different scenarios. Let's start...

Aug 6, 2024



```
2 -> any any (msg: "Troubleshooting 1"; sid:10
```



In this continuation, we will further explore sophisticated methods for analyzing traffic data and enhancing security measures.

+

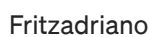


t come with signatures. Put your local

```

: "FOX-SRT - Exploit - Possible Apache Log4j RCE Request Observed (CVE-2021-44228)"; flow:established, to_server; content:
: "FOX-SRT - Exploit - Possible Apache Log4j RCE Request Observed (CVE-2021-44228)"; flow:established, to_server; content:
: "FOX-SRT - Exploit - Possible Defense-Evasive Apache Log4j RCE Request Observed (CVE-2021-44228)"; flow:established, to_s
: "FOX-SRT - Exploit - Possible Defense-Evasive Apache Log4j RCE Request Observed (URL encoded bracket) (CVE-2021-44228)";
: "FOX-SRT - Exploit - Possible Apache Log4j Exploit Attempt in HTTP Header"; flow:established, to_server; content:"${"; ht
: "FOX-SRT - Exploit - Possible Apache Log4j Exploit Attempt in URI"; flow:established,to_server; content:"${"; http_uri; f
  detects evasion techniques
: "FOX-SRT - Exploit - Possible Apache Log4j Exploit Attempt in HTTP Header (strict)"; flow:established,to_server; content:
: "FOX-SRT - Exploit - Possible Apache Log4j Exploit Attempt in URI (strict)"; flow:established, to_server; content:"${"; h
: "FOX-SRT - Exploit - Possible Apache Log4j Exploit Attempt in Client Body (strict)"; flow:to server; content:"${"; http_c

```



In this final part, we'll complete our journey in understanding how Snort works, review the insights gained, and discuss final steps to...

Aug 7, 2024



Fritzadriano

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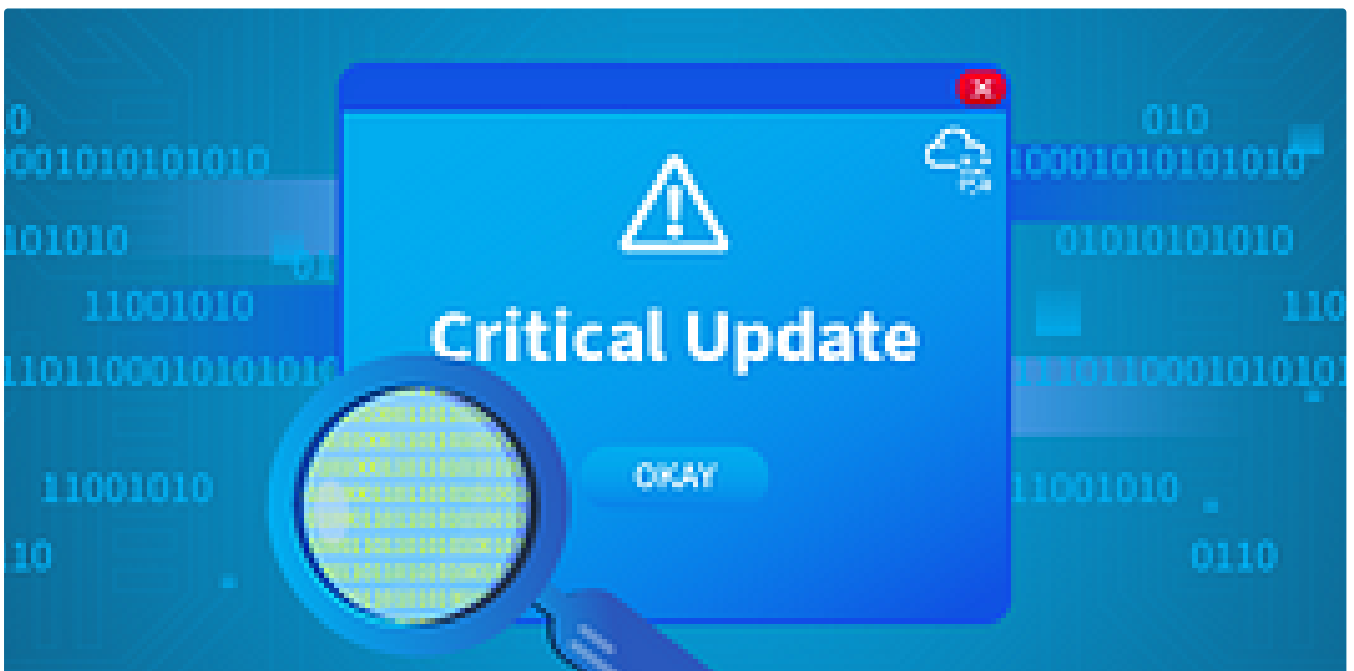


rutbar

TryHackMe—Logs Fundamentals | Cyber Security 101 (THM)

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★ Oct 26, 2024



In T3CH by Axoloth

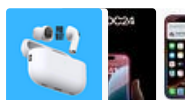
TryHackMe | Critical | WriteUp

Acquire the basic skills to analyze a memory dump in a practical scenario.

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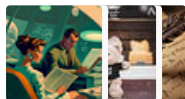


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```
d
rd.img.old  lib64      media  opt    root  sbin  srv  tmp  var      vmlinuz.old
            lost+found mnt    proc   run   snap  sys  usr    vmlinuz
var/log
log# ls
cloud-init-output.log  dpkg.log      kern.log      lxd      unattended-upgrades
cloud-init.log         fontconfig.log  landscape     syslog   wtmp
dist-upgrade          journal       lastlog       tallylog
log# cat auth.log | grep install
8-55 sudo: cybert : TTY=pts/0 ; PWD=/home/cybert ; USER=root ; COMMAND=/usr/bin/
8-55 sudo: cybert : TTY=pts/0 ; PWD=/home/cybert ; USER=root ; COMMAND=/usr/bin/
8-55 sudo: cybert : TTY=pts/0 ; PWD=/home/cybert ; USER=root ; COMMAND=/bin/chow
hare/dokuwiki/bin /usr/share/dokuwiki/doku.php /usr/share/dokuwiki/feed.php /usr/s
hare/dokuwiki/install.php /usr/share/dokuwiki/lib /usr/share/dokuwiki/vendor -R
log#
```

Dan Molina

Disgruntled CTF Walkthrough

This is a great CTF on TryHackMe that can be accessed through this link here:

<https://tryhackme.com/room/disgruntled>

Oct 22, 2024



High (CVSS: 10.0)
NVT: OpenVAS / Greenbone Vulnerability Manager Default Credentials (OID: 1.3.6.1.4.1.25623.1.0.108554)

Product detection result: cpe:/a:openvas:openvas_manager:7.0 by OpenVAS / Greenbone Vulnerability Manager Detection (OID: 1.3.6.1.4.1.25623.1.0.103825)

Summary

The remote OpenVAS / Greenbone Vulnerability Manager is installed/configured in a way that it has account(s) with default passwords enabled.

Vulnerability Detection Result

It was possible to login using the following credentials (username:password:role):

admin:admin:Admin

Impact

This issue may be exploited by a remote attacker to gain access to sensitive information or modify system configuration.

Solution

Solution type: Workaround

Change the password of the mentioned account(s).

Vulnerability Insight

It was possible to login with default credentials: admin/admin, sadmin/changeme, observer/observer or admin/openvas.

 embossdotar

TryHackMe—Vulnerability Scanner Overview—Writeup

Key points: Vulnerability scanners | Vulnerability scanning | CVE | CVSS | OpenVAS.
Vulnerability Scanner Overview by awesome TryHackMe! 🎉

 Oct 22, 2024

 65

 1





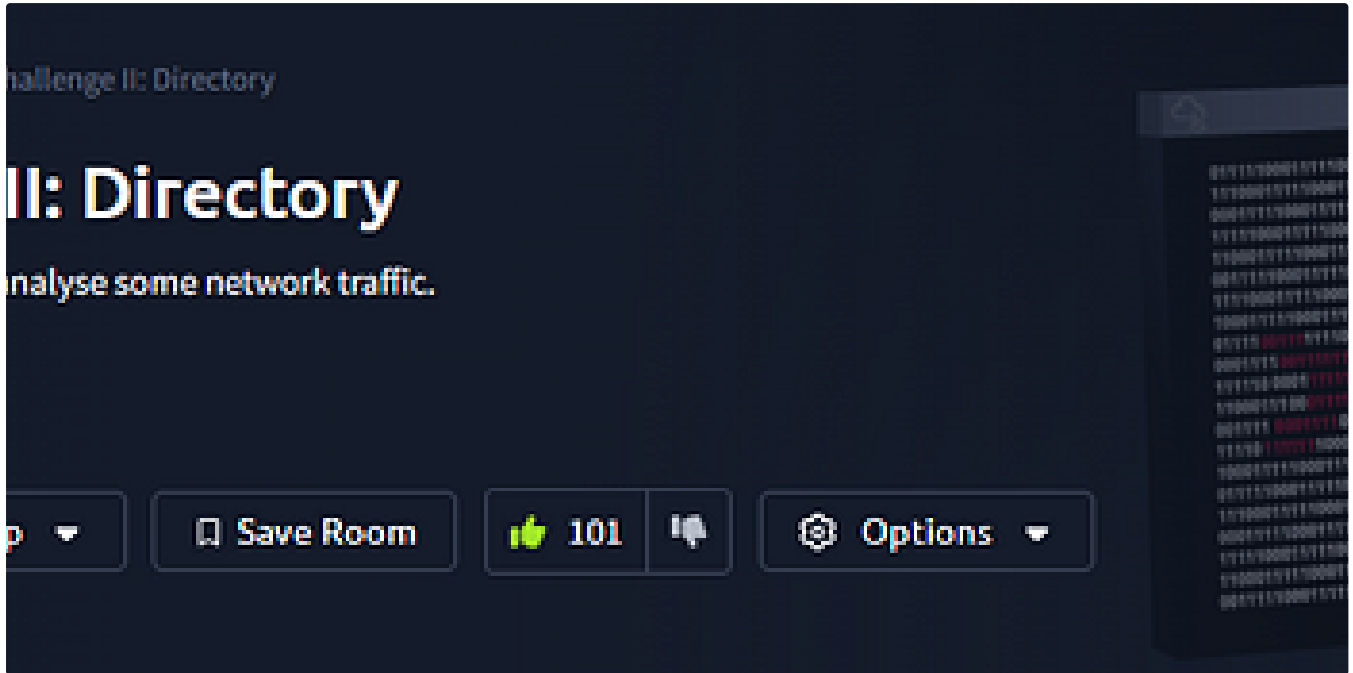


 rutbar

TryHackMe—Firewall Fundamentals | Cyber Security 101 (THM)

A firewall acts like a security guard for digital devices and networks, checking all incoming and outgoing data. Just as a physical guard...

★ Oct 26, 2024 3 1



 Abhijeet Singh

TShark Challenge II: Directory | SOC Level 1 | TryHackMe Walkthrough

Task 1 Introduction

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